

MARKDOWN FORMATTING GUIDE — authoring for the DOCX renderer

Working document

Corpus	01_HLS_MS149_Floyd_ff81r-83v
Source	markdown_formatting_guide.md
Integrity	sha256 43bd43177a7b · rendered 2026-07-09
Status	<i>Derived render for review. The markdown source file governs; the modernized layer is never quotable; all readings are provisional pending the commissioned professional transcription (names above all). Canonical apparatus: <code>_PRECISION_PASS_LEDGER.md</code>; method: <code>TRANSCRIPTION_AND_ANALYSIS_METHODOLOGY.md</code>.</i>

How to read this render (conventions legend)

strikethrough	struck in the manuscript (source: <code>~~text~~</code>)
superscript	scribal interlineation or raised letters (source: <code>^text^</code> , <code>m^r</code>)
shaded serif span	diplomatic text quoted inline (source: <code>`text`</code>); conventions inside are rendered too
boxed serif panel	diplomatic transcription block
gray italic <code>[[...]]</code>	pass-annotation — editorial apparatus, NOT manuscript text
CONFIRM UPGRADE LEAN CONFLICT	delta-log verdict class: green = confirmed/convergent · blue = upgraded/new · amber = lean/open/variant · red = retraction/conflict
<code>[?] / [...] / [] · « » · · △ ✓ eB X</code> ★	sigla printed verbatim per methodology §6/§9

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Scope: every working/reviewer markdown file in this corpus directory. **Renderer:** `../_working_docx_renderer.py` (shared across manuscript corpora: STAC_8_203_38, HLS_MS149_Floyd_ff81r-83v). **Output:** `docx_exports/<name>.docx`, with a legend page and a source-sha256 footer.

```
python3 ../_working_docx_renderer.py <file.md> [more.md ...] [-o OUTDIR]
python3 ../_working_docx_renderer.py <corpus_dir>          # batch: renders the whole
# reviewer set (_WORKING_*.md, READING_COMPANION*, ledger, concordance,
# corrections log, READMEs, hand atlases, this guide)
python3 ../_working_docx_renderer.py --pdf <corpus_dir> [...] # + silent PDF
# into docx_exports/pdfs/. Word takes NO focus and shows NO window
# (launch + hidden document, per the kirchner_tools pattern); your own
# open Word documents are untouched.

# THE STANDING WORKFLOW: after ANY formatter change, reconvert everything -
python3 ../_working_docx_renderer.py --pdf "01_HLS_MS149_Floyd_ff81r-83v"
"02_STAC_8_203_38"
```

Governing rules (before any formatting question):

- 1. The markdown source governs.** The DOCX is a derived render; never edit content in Word and never treat a render as authority. The footer's sha256 pins each render to the exact source state — a stale render is detectable, not dangerous.
- 2. Never rewrite the evidence layer to please the renderer.** Existing `_WORKING_*` files are the transcription record; the renderer adapts to THEM (Mode B below). New reviewer-facing documents may be authored in the explicit tag format (Mode A).
- 3. The diplomatic conventions are semantics, not style** (methodology §6, §9). The renderer's job is to make them *visible* (real strikethrough, real superscript) without ever *altering* them.

1. INLINE CONVENTIONS (work everywhere: paragraphs, tables, panels, cells)

You write	Renders as	Meaning
<code>text</code>	strikethrough	struck in the manuscript (scribal deletion)
<code>word</code>	^{superscript}	scribal interlineation
<code>m^r, vj^{te}, Ex[?]^[2]</code>	^{superscript cluster}	raised letters / superscript abbreviation

You write	Renders as	Meaning
<code>text</code>	superscript and struck	struck interlineation (revision stack)
<code>text</code>	shaded Cambria span	diplomatic text quoted inline — conventions inside the backticks are rendered too (Edwardes = shaded + struck)
<code>[[4B: note]]</code>	gray italic, brackets kept	pass-annotation — editorial apparatus, NOT manuscript text
bold , <i>italic</i>	bold / italic	emphasis (apparatus voice)
<code>[?] [...] [] « » <x> Λ</code>	verbatim	uncertain / supplied / illegible / insertion / expansion / cuts & seams / caret — printed as-is, they ARE the record
<code>△ △ △ ✓ ✓ ✓ ✓ eB X ★ ● ○ □</code>	verbatim	status codes per methodology §9

Caret disambiguation (only subtle rule in the grammar): a caret directly after a word/bracket character opens a SHORT raised cluster (`mr` → superscript r); a caret after a space/start opens a PAIRED interlineation and needs its closer (`said`). If an interlineation follows a word with no space, put a space before the caret. Paired interlineations must close within ~90 characters — longer insertions belong in a `[[...]]` note or their own line.

Escaping: there is none. If you need a literal `~~` or `^` (almost never — the legend documents syntax by example), rephrase or wrap in a `[[...]]` note.

2. MODE B — THE WORKING-FILE RECOGNIZER (existing ``_WORKING_*` conventions)

The renderer detects these exact shapes. Keep new working files inside them and the render is automatic.

2.1 Headings → banners

```
# FILE TITLE          -> dark title banner (page 1; first # only)
## LEFT HALF-COLUMN (x 0.05-0.55) -> full-width DARK section banner
## Band 3 (src y 1062-1698) - ... -> LIGHT sub-banner ("Band N" prefix triggers it)
### / ####           -> ordinary bold headings
---                  -> horizontal rule
```

2.2 Census-line bullets → three-column Lines table

```
- L12: `w[i]th him a greate[?] |` - note text here
- c3: `R[?]u[?]l[...] |`
- b7: `[?]o[?]nte[?] of the bill ...`
```

Shape: - LABEL: \diplomatic\ — apparatus-note. Labels matching c/L/b/R + number (+letter) (e.g. L12, c3, L1b, L8–L9) become the bold anchor column; the backticked text becomes the Cambria column; anything after — becomes the gray apparatus column. Consecutive census bullets merge into ONE table —

a caption line immediately above (e.g. **CAPTION BLOCK (...)** / **DEPOSITION LINES (...)**) becomes the table caption.

Generic form (any corpus's label convention): - **LABEL:** \diplomatic\ — note — ANY bold label up to ~64 chars ending in a colon, immediately followed by a backticked span, is a census row; the label prints verbatim (qualifiers included). This is how the HLS folio.line labels work: - **81r.6 L (¶ opener, big swash majuscule):** \<T/S>he <plt> ...\ — THREE questions.... The label column widens automatically for long labels. Bold-opener bullets WITHOUT a following backtick span stay ordinary bullets (safe for **eB queue after L b1-2:** ... and similar).

2.3 Band records → two-column table

```
- **b1 (caption):** `xam[inati]o capt~...` · `[An]no regni ...`
```

- **bN ...:** tokens rows merge into a band table (anchor | tokens).

2.4 Blockquotes — three renders by content

```
> **ffrom. / W[ho]e gave you Instruciones ...**      -> boxed diplomatic PANEL
>                                                     (warm off-white, Cambria)
> ★ (1) commentary sentence ...                     -> indented apparatus commentary
> [[PHASE 4B FOLD-IN ...]] ...                       -> bordered gray note panel
```

Blank > lines split panels. Inside one panel, a new line starting with *(margin ...)*, **N**, a digit+./:, or ★ begins a new visual paragraph.

2.5 Stitched composites → anchor/text table

```
> **L1** John Towneley of [C]raue[n?] ... · **L1b** (right half only) ... ·
> **L2** To the 3[d?] Interr[ogatorie] ...
```

The chain separator · immediately before **Ln** splits rows; each **anchor** gets its own left cell. The manuscript's own / virgules are untouched.

2.6 Census summaries → shaded box

Any paragraph beginning **Census:** renders as a shaded summary box.

2.7 Delta logs → chip-classified entries

```
1. **CONFIRM (eyes-on, independent):** body ...
2. **UPGRADE — baseline `[bringing]` (supplied) → eyes-read** `bring[in]g[e][?]' ...
10. **RETRACTIONS (my own in-pass leads):** ...
```

Numbered items whose bold text OPENS with a verdict word get a colored chip:

Chip color	Verdict words
green	CONFIRM, CONVERGENCE
blue	UPGRADE, NEW, STRUCTURE
amber	LEAN, OPEN, VARIANT

Chip color	Verdict words
red	RETRACTION(S), CONFLICT

Use these words as the FIRST word of the bold opener; anything else renders as a plain numbered entry (no chip — fine for non-verdict lists).

2.8 Markdown tables

Standard `| a | b |` tables render with shaded header row and full conventions inside cells.

3. MODE A — THE EXPLICIT MS-TAG FORMAT (new reviewer documents)

For newly authored documents (reviewer summaries, crux sheets, collation reports), write the structure explicitly — same grammar family as the DDC exhibit format. Tags sit alone on their line.

```
[TITLE: MEMBRANE 009 — REVIEWER CRUX SHEET]

[META]
Corpus: TNA STAC 8/203/38 (record copy RC8368179)
Leaf: membrane 009 (Articles 13-16)
Status: readings provisional pending professional transcription
[/META]

[SECTION: THE STRUCK REWARD QUESTION]

[DIPLOMATIC]
~~[Did they give?] anie r[e]ward, [tendred?] or [pro]mised [__] [to/by?]
the ^said^ M[r] Barker [__] / and[?] what was the[?] cause the[re]of[?]]~~
[/DIPLOMATIC]

[COMMENT]
Two cramped lines squeezed between L8 and the Art-14 opener — an
afterthought insertion, then struck entire. [[multispectral target]]
[/COMMENT]

[HEADER: WHAT THE REVIEWER SHOULD CHECK]

[LINES: Art-13 zone, membrane 009]
L8 | `name him or them that did soe doe.` | precedes the struck zone
L8a | `~anie r[e]ward [tendred?] or [pro]mised~` | the struck insertion
[/LINES]

[CENSUS]
31 lines + rotated 4-line endorsement; foot otherwise blank; unsigned.
[/CENSUS]

[DELTA: 3 | OPEN]
The party-styling cluster "Adfe[c/r]t" leads "ad sect[am] Barker" — not
asserted anywhere; USER + TNA arbitration first.
```

```
[FOOTNOTE: Tiles: crops/stac_p4b/_manifest.jsonl; ledger item D12.]
```

```
[END]
```

Tag	Renders as
[TITLE: ...]	cover title (also drives the banner if no # heading)
[META] key: value ... [/META]	boxed two-column metadata table
[SECTION: NAME] ... [/SECTION]	dark banner; closing tag draws a rule
[HEADER: NAME]	light sub-banner
[LINES: caption] rows [/LINES]	Lines table; each row LABEL text note (text column may use backticks; conventions render)
[DIPLOMATIC] ... [/DIPLOMATIC]	boxed diplomatic panel (Cambria)
[COMMENT] ... [/COMMENT]	indented apparatus commentary
[CENSUS] ... [/CENSUS]	shaded census box
[DELTA: n VERDICT] body	numbered entry with verdict chip (vocabulary in §2.7)
[FOOTNOTE: ...]	gray apparatus note
[END]	stop rendering (anything after is ignored)

Both modes may be mixed in one file; the tag form wins wherever it appears.

4. WHAT THE RENDERER ADDS AUTOMATICALLY (do not author these)

- **Title block:** dark banner from the first #/[TITLE:], document-class subtitle (inferred from the filename: LINE_INDEX / TRANSCRIPTION / LEDGER / COMPANION), Source/Integrity/Status metadata box, and the provisionality rubric.
- **Conventions legend** with live exemplars (real strike, real superscript, real chips).
- **Contents inventory** (documents with ≥ 6 sections): a compact section/band list after the legend. No page numbers by design — banners are real Heading-styled paragraphs, so **Word's navigation pane (View → Sidebar → Navigation) gives live jumps**; the printed list is the inventory for PDF readers.
- **Pagination hygiene:** banners never split across pages and stay with their content; table rows never split mid-row; multi-page Lines tables repeat their header row.
- **Monochrome sigla:**  is pinned to a symbol font in amber ink so it renders as a scholarly glyph, never a color emoji — author it as the plain  character and let the renderer handle presentation.
- **Footer on every page:** <source>.md · sha256 <12 hex> · p. N of M. After editing a source file, re-run the renderer; a reviewer can always detect a stale render by hashing the .md.

5. AUTHORING CHECKLIST (run before rendering anything new)

- [] Diplomatic text is inside backticks (inline) or panels/Lines rows — never bare in apparatus prose.
- [] Every , ,  pairs off (grep-count the delimiters; odd counts = a leak).

- [] Census bullets follow - LABEL: \text\ — note exactly (colon after label, backticks, spaced em-dash).
- [] Delta verdicts use the §2.7 vocabulary as the first bold word.
- [] Modernized-layer text is clearly labeled and never inside backticks or [DIPLOMATIC] (it must not look quotable).
- [] Render, open the DOCX, and check the ONE thing machines miss: that nothing which is *your* voice ended up styled as *manuscript* voice (Cambria/panel/shaded), or vice versa. Voice confusion is the only render error that can mislead a reviewer.

Cross-references: conventions & status codes — ../TRANSCRIPTION_AND_ANALYSIS_METHODOLOGY.md §6, §9; renderer source (rendering contract in its docstring) — ../_working_docx_render.py; reviewer package — README_FOR_REVIEWERS.md.